Cornell University

ROPER CENTER

31098709
USVRS1992-STELEC-DC

Country: United States

Title: VRS 1992 District of Columbia Election Day Exit Poll

Survey Organizations: Voter Research & Surveys

Sponsors: ABC News; CBS News; NBC News; CNN

Field Dates: November 3, 1992

Sample: Exiting Voters in District of Columbia

Sample Size: 584

Interview Modes: Mail questionnaire/Self-enumerated questionnaire

Weight Location: Columns 75-80 (xxx.xxx)

Usage Notes: Read all documentation before running data. A blank always represents an omit or non-response. Numerical values for the PRECINCT variable do not correspond with actual precinct numbers. Data labels for this variable have been removed to ensure respondent confidentiality.

Please note that data provided by the Roper Center for Public Opinion Research may not be re-disseminated without written permission. The results of any analyses conducted on the data may, however, be published with appropriate acknowledgments and source citation.

Voter Research & Surveys State Exit Poll Usage Notes:

Weights
Columns 75-80 contain respondent weights. These weights should be applied in all analyses. The weight has 3 implied decimal places, where '164222' in columns 75-80 means the respondent's weights=164.222

For additional information, see the Weighting section in the addendum on sampling procedures.

Backside Variable
When Column 66=1, there was at least one response on the backside of the questionnaire, which indicates that the questionnaire was turned over. This could allow the researcher to omit respondents when analyzing backside items

"Q" Vote
Original responses to Vote questions are in Columns 33, 34, 36, 37 with the descriptions QPresidential Vote, QSenate Vote, QGovernor Vote and QHouse Vote.

Columns 22, 23, 24, 25 with the descriptions Presidential, Senate, Governor and House Vote are responses to the same questions above, except that the "Other" and "Didn't vote" responses are recoded to "Blank". These columns were used for all broadcast and published analyses of VRS data.

Additional Items
Some items, not on the questionnaire, are added to the datasets. All surveys have the following add-ons:

Column Location	Description
65	State or National Questionnaire: 1=National 2=State
66	Completed Backside of Exit Poll (where appropriate): 1=Yes 2=No
68	Age (4 Categories): 1=18-29 2=30-44 3=45-59 4=60 and Over

69	Age (6 Categories)	
	1=18-24	2=25-29
	3=30-34	4=40-49
	5=50-59	6=60 and Over

71	Age 65 (6 Categories):	
	1=18-24	2=25-29
	3=30-39	4=40-49
	5=50-64	6=65 and Over

The various ages (Cols. 68, 69, 71) are regroupings of the original 8 category Age question in Column 19.

70	Party ID: (3 Categories)	
	1=Democrat	
	2=Republican	
	3=Independent/Else	

Party ID is a regrouping of the 4 category Party ID in column 48.

*72	# of responses to the Issues question:
	1, 2, or Blank

*Only in states with survey asking which issues mattered most

75-80	Weight	(3 implied decimals)

17	Call Number	1- First Call
		2- Second Call
		3- Third Call

Interviewers called in results three times during election day. Call number indicates from which call a respondent came.

State Surveys

In each state a sample of exit poll precincts is drawn. Respondents in these precincts are given a "state" questionnaire. However, a subsample of these precincts is selected to be part of the VRS National sample, where respondents in these precincts are given a "national" questionnaire (instead of the "state" questionnaire). Since the national questionnaire has several items in common with the state questionnaire, a sample of national respondents is included in the state exit poll dataset. Column 65 indicates whether the respondent completed the state or national poll.

"State-Only" Questions

Items asked only on state questionnaires are marked with an asterisk (*) on the column location documentation. Select only respondents to the state poll, Column 65 = 2, when analyzing these "state-only" questions. National respondents will have a "blank" in those "state-only" columns since those items were not asked of them on the national questionnaire.

Blanks

A blank always represents an omit, or non-response to an item. However, there are two exceptions.

1) On checklist-type questions, such as "Do any of the following apply to you?" or "Were any of the items below very important in your presidential choice?", each of the listed items are coded '1' if they are checked and "blank" if not checked.

2) Responses to state-only questions on national questionnaires are left blank. As mentioned above, select only state questionnaires when analyzing state-only items in order to distinguish blanks that are true omits from inapplicable national questionnaires.

Add-on items

Column Location	Description
67	Geo Code (2 to 5 categories): VRS geographic region within a state (See column location documentation for codes)

Addendum

Sample Selection – The state samples were selected in two stages. First, a probability sample of voting precincts was selected that represented the different geographic areas across the state and the vote by party. Precincts were selected with a probability proportionate to the number of voters in each precinct. Each voter in the state has the same chance to have his or her precinct selected. There is one exception. In some states, precincts that have large minority populations have been sampled at a higher rate than other precincts. The sample weighting (described below) adjusts the representation of these precincts to their correct share of the total vote.

The national sample is a subsample of the state sample precincts. The probability of selecting these precincts is the same as if the sample had been selected at a uniform rate nationwide, and minority precincts had been selected again at a higher rate.

Within both state and national sample precincts voters were selected systematically throughout the voting day at a rate that gives all voters in a precinct the same chance of being interviewed.

Sampling Error – The error due to sampling depends on, among other things the number of respondents in each group. For example, if there are 1,500 respondents total in a sample, the sampling error on the percentage of men voting for a candidate depends on the number of men in the poll. In this example, if there are 750 men, the table below shows that the sampling error for 750 respondents to a typical question is 5.0%.

The sampling errors below are for most voter groups. There are 95 chances in 100 that a sample result is within this many percentage points of the result that would have been obtained by trying to interview every voter.

The sampling error also depends on how many precincts have voters with the characteristic of interest. For example, black or high income voters may be found clustered in only a few sample precincts. A characteristic that is clustered in a few precincts has a larger sampling error than characteristics that are not clustered such as age or sex. The sampling error may be up to 3 times larger for clustered characteristics.

Respondents in base of percentage	Error due to sampling
100	13.0%
250	8.0
500	6.0
750	5.0
1,000	4.0
1,500	3.5
2,000	3.0
2,500	2.5
5,000	2.0
7,500	1.5
10,000	1.3
12,500	1.1
15,000	1.1

Weighting – The tabulated results are weighted to reflect the different probabilities of selecting a precinct and of selecting a voter within each precinct. Minority precincts, that were selected at a higher rate, received a smaller weight than other precincts of the same size. For voters who are missed or refuse to be interviewed, there also is an adjustment which is based on their observed age, race and sex. Precincts in the national sample are weighted to regional totals during the day so that incomplete regional tallies can be combined in their correct proportions to form a national tally. Tabulations are meaningful only if they are weighted. Unweighted tabulations will make no sense.

Questionnaires – Respondents in national exit poll precincts will be given one of the four versions of the national questionnaire. Two versions have the identical questions: however, the response categories for the "important issues" and "candidate qualities" questions are in reverse order on the two versions of those questionnaires. (The state polls ask these questions in fixed order only.) The questions on these two national versions combined will be answered by about 7,000 voters. Each of the other two versions will have different questions. Those versions will have 3,500 respondents each.

All national poll questionnaires will ask the presidential vote, the vote for House and some common demographics. House of Representatives candidates are identified by party only on the questionnaires. Each interviewer has a list of the House candidates on the ballot at their precinct. In Congressional districts with uncontested races the sole candidate is automatically checked as the winner.

The questionnaires in each state differ somewhat. There is only one state questionnaire in each state except California; it has two questionnaires, with mostly different questions on each. There are eight questions common to all states: age, sex, race, income, vote for President in 1988, party identification, condition of the national economy, and personal financial situation. There are additional questions in each state.

State tabulations can have questions based on different sample sizes. If a question appears only on a state exit poll questionnaire, it will have a smaller sample size than will questions that are on both the state and the national questionnaire used in that state. The sample sizes on the top of the state exit poll documentation are the total sample sizes for the state and national questionnaires combined.

VOTER RESEARCH & SURVEYS

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA
GENERAL ELECTION 1992

Your answers are confidential
Please do not sign your name

A Are You:
1 ☐ Male 2 ☐ Female

B Are You:
1 ☐ White
2 ☐ Black
3 ☐ Hispanic/Latino
4 ☐ Asian
5 ☐ Other

C In Today's Election For President, Did You Just Vote For:
1 ☐ Bill Clinton (Dem)
2 ☐ George Bush (Rep)
3 ☐ Ross Perot (Ind)
4 ☐ Other: Who?_____
5 ☐ Didn't vote for President

D Do You Think That The Condition Of The Nation's Economy Is:
1 ☐ Excellent
2 ☐ Good
3 ☐ Not so good
4 ☐ Poor

E Who Did You Vote For In The 1988 Presidential Election?
1 ☐ George Bush (Rep)
2 ☐ Michael Dukakis (Dem)
3 ☐ Someone else
4 ☐ Did not vote in 1988

F To Which Age Group Do You Belong?
1 ☐ 18-24
2 ☐ 25-29
3 ☐ 30-39
4 ☐ 40-44
5 ☐ 45-49
6 ☐ 50-59
7 ☐ 60-64
8 ☐ 65 or over

G No Matter How You Voted Today, Do You Usually Think Of Yourself As A:
1 ☐ Democrat
2 ☐ Republican
3 ☐ Independent
4 ☐ Something else

H How Did You Vote On The Initiative Measure To Increase The Penalty For First Degree Murder To Death Or Life Imprisonment In The District Of Columbia?
1 ☐ For the initiative
2 ☐ Against the initiative
3 ☐ Did not vote on the initiative

I Compared To Four Years Ago, Is Your Family's Financial Situation:
1 ☐ Better today
2 ☐ Worse today
3 ☐ About the same

J 1991 Total Family Income:
1 ☐ Under $15,000
2 ☐ $15,000-$29,999
3 ☐ $30,000-$49,999
4 ☐ $50,000-$74,999
5 ☐ $75,000 or over

Please fold the questionnaire and put it in the box. Thank you.

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Voter Research and Survey Exit Poll

District Of Coulmbia General Election Exit Poll
November 3, 1992

Total number of respondents : 584

COLUMN LOCATIONS		DESCRIPTIONS [Question ID]
1		'1'
2 - 6		Sequence Number (00001 - XXXXX)
7		'G'
8		'0'
9 - 10		State Number DC = '09'
11 - 13		Precinct Number
14 - 16		Sequence Number Within Precinct
17		Call Number: 1=First Call 2=Second Call 3=Third Call
18		'1'
19		Age(8 categories): 1=18-24 2=25-29 3=30-39 4=40-44 5=45-49 6=50-59 7=60-64 8=65 or over
20		Race [B]: 1=White 2=Black 3=Hispanic/Latino 4=Asian 5=Other
21		Sex [A]
22		Presidential Vote [C]
33		QPresidential Vote (VRS)
35	*	Death Penalty Initiative [H]
45		88 Presidential Vote [E]

COLUMN LOCATIONS	DESCRIPTIONS [Question ID]	(DC)
48	Party ID [G]: (4 Categories) 1=Democrat 2=Republican 3=Independent 4=Else	
50	Nation's Economy [D]	
53	Financial Situation [I]	
54	Family Income [J] 1=Under 15K 2=15-30K 3=30-50K 4=50-75K 5=Over 75K	
65	State or National Poll : 1=National 2=State	
66	Completed Backside of Exit Poll: 1=Yes 2=No	
67	Geo Code: 1=NE/SE/SW 2=West Of Rock Creek	(VRS)
68	Age (4 Categories): 1=18 - 29 2=30 - 44 3=45 - 59 4=60 and Over	(VRS)
69	Age (6 Categories): 1=18 - 24 2=25 - 29 3=30 - 39 4=40 - 49 5=50 - 59 6=60 and Over	(VRS)
70	Party ID: (3 Categories) 1=Democrat 2=Republican 3=Independent/Other	(VRS)
75-80	WEIGHT (3 implied decimal places)	

SINGLE COL FREQUENCIES FOR USVRS1992-STELEC-DC (COLS. 1-80) / NCARDS 584

COL	&	-	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	BLANK	OTHER	NONBLNK	COL
1	0	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	1
2	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	2
3	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	3
4	0	0	99	100	100	100	100	85	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	4
5	0	0	59	60	60	60	60	60	60	60	55	50	0	0	584	5
6	0	0	58	59	59	59	59	58	58	58	58	58	0	0	584	6
7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	584	7
8	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	8
9	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	9
10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	584	10
11	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	11
12	0	0	179	77	187	141	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	12
13	0	0	110	0	65	115	79	32	33	0	70	80	0	0	584	13
14	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	14
15	0	0	134	145	143	107	30	14	10	1	0	0	0	0	584	15
16	0	0	54	66	66	64	59	58	54	54	54	55	0	0	584	16
17	0	0	0	123	233	228	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	17
18	0	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	18
19	0	0	0	67	93	154	78	50	69	29	43	0	1	0	583	19
20	0	0	0	220	339	12	3	8	0	0	0	0	2	0	582	20
21	0	0	0	249	320	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0	569	21
22	0	0	0	494	44	27	0	0	0	0	0	0	19	0	565	22
23	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	23
24	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	24
25	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	25
26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	26
27	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	27
28	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	28
29	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	29
30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	30
31	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	31
32	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	32
33	0	0	0	494	44	27	14	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	33
34	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	34
35	0	0	0	164	379	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	41	0	543	35
36	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	36
37	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	37
38	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	38
39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	39
40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	40
41	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	41
42	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	42
43	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	43
44	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	44
45	0	0	0	104	326	37	109	0	0	0	0	0	8	0	576	45
46	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	46
47	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	47
48	0	0	0	431	50	83	11	0	0	0	0	0	9	0	575	48
49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	49
50	0	0	0	6	40	248	287	0	0	0	0	0	3	0	581	50
51	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	51
52	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	52
53	0	0	0	109	266	201	0	0	0	0	0	0	8	0	576	53
54	0	0	0	73	172	153	85	83	0	0	0	0	18	0	566	54
55	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	55
56	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	56
57	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	57
58	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	58
59	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	59
60	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	60
61	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	61
62	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	62
63	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	63
64	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	64
65	0	0	0	30	554	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	65
66	0	0	0	29	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	554	0	30	66
67	0	0	0	483	101	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	67
68	0	0	0	160	232	119	72	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	583	68
69	0	0	0	67	93	154	128	69	72	0	0	0	1	0	583	69
70	0	0	0	431	50	94	0	0	0	0	0	0	9	0	575	70
71	0	0	0	67	93	154	128	98	43	0	0	0	1	0	583	71
72	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	72
73	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	73
74	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	0	0	74
75	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	75
76	0	0	584	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	76
77	0	0	337	246	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	584	77
78	0	0	91	18	18	38	50	27	85	89	96	72	0	0	584	78
79	0	0	50	51	59	41	42	59	82	71	79	50	0	0	584	79
80	0	0	65	62	97	24	53	70	47	47	50	69	0	0	584	80